# Acknowledgements

NORMALLY, IT is difficult to remember events that took place some forty years ago. If you somehow remember them, it is even more difficult to place them within a precise timeframe. But when the events happen to be of great national importance, they get embedded in your memory and don't leave it easily. In fact, with the passage of time, the burden of memories of those events compels you to unload it in one form or the other, without further delay. For me, writing a book about the events described here was the most suitable choice to unburden myself.

The contents of this book revolve around a two-phased, top-secret operation, which I name 'Operation Bhindranwale-Khalistan'. It was initiated and managed by some senior and influential Congress leaders operating from the prime minister's residential office at 1 Akbar Road, New Delhi. Normally, no records are kept of such operations, and everything is decided verbally. However, as that operation had some external ramifications, the R&AW became involved in one form or the other. It was in that context that I had my own personal experiences and insights related to the operation, and they form the core of this book.

However, additional information was required to fill in some gaps. Most newspapers, journals and the other media, suitably 'managed' by the Government of India's officers and agencies concerned, gave coloured, if not distorted, views of the developments. The rest could not grasp the true nature of the operation and got carried away by the meticulously managed flow of events. Even so, some publications like *India Today* and the *Indian Express* among others, provided useful information. Credit for such articles and news items quoted from these publications has been provided.